Read with audio

Step 2: two free sources, one method, a 4-week schedule

Two free sources, nothing else

Source	Level	Why	Link
MeloLingua: Il Caffè della Mattina, Al Mercato, Il Gelato Perfetto, In Treno verso Firenze, La Cena della Nonna	A1	Native audio, glossary and comprehension questions, about 600 words total. No signup for these 5 stories.	Open stories
The Fable Cottage: Cenerentola, Biancaneve, Hansel e Gretel, Jack e il fagiolo magico, I tre capretti furbetti and 5 more	A1–A2	Italian + English text with audio, most with animated video. 10 free stories.	Story list · Cenerentola

Method (10–15 min per story section)

- **1. Read and listen at once.** Follow the text while the audio plays. Do not stop.
- **2. Cognate scan.** Underline every word you recognised from English. You understand more than you think.
- **3. Read again, aloud.** Look up at most 5 words. Write whole chunks, not single words.
- **4. Retell.** Close it and say what happened in 4–6 sentences. Say it badly; that is the point.

Retell it in four sentences

After a story section, close the page and say four sentences out loud in Italian about what happened. Speaking aloud matters more than writing. Short and wrong is fine.

The four sentences

- **1. Who and where?** *Sara entra in un bar.*
- **2. What does the person want or do?** *Ha sonno e vuole un caffè.*
- **3. What happens next?** *Ordina un cappuccino e un cornetto.*
- **4. How does it end?** *Paga con la carta ed esce.*

Keep it simple

- Use the present tense and words you remember from the story. Cognates are welcome.
- Do not translate from English. If you are stuck, say a simpler sentence, or say the missing word in English and carry on.
- New to this? Start with two sentences and build up to four.
- The examples above only show the shape. Your sentences come from the story you just read.

Then check yourself

- Reopen the text and compare. Find two or three phrases you missed or got wrong.
- Log each one in the app's Gaps log. They become flashcards, so you only study what you actually missed.
- Come back to the same story a few days later. Your retelling should get easier.

Schedule

Week	Read
1	MeloLingua: Il Caffè della Mattina, Al Mercato, Il Gelato Perfetto
2	MeloLingua: In Treno verso Firenze, La Cena della Nonna. Then re-read your favourite one with no English.
3	Fable Cottage: Cenerentola and I tre capretti furbetti
4	Fable Cottage: Biancaneve and one more of your choice. [B1] Retell it in 8 sentences and record yourself.

Reading log

Story	Chunks I learned (write 5)	My retelling in one sentence